Jon Wick

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Summary

Molecular and computational biologist experienced in Western blots, PCR, sterile cell culture, and bioinformatic genomic analysis. Seeking a laboratory technician position applying these skills to immunology and cancer research.

Education

B.S. Molecular and Cellular Biology, Computer Science minor — September 2023 – June 2026
Western Washington University – Bellingham, WA
Outstanding Graduate, WWU Dept of Biology 2026

Research Experience

Undergraduate Researcher, Lee Lab, WWU – Bellingham, WA — June 2024 – Present

- Investigate small non-coding RNA roles in an RNAi pathway maintaining genome integrity in *Tetrahymena thermophila* using Western Blot, cell culture, and bioinformatics.
- Develop custom pipelines in Python and R for genome-wide sRNA biogenesis loci identification and differential expression analysis.
- Present findings at lab meetings, journal clubs, and WWU SURP poster sessions.

Advanced Molecular and Cell Lab – BIOL 487, WWU — Spring 2025

- Investigated ER-associated protein degradation (ERAD) via *ubc-6* in *C. elegans*, relevant to protein quality control in cancer and neurodegeneration.
- Performed Western Blots, RT-PCR, and endpoint PCR to quantify misfolded protein accumulation in *ubc-6* knockout lines.
- Co-authored a poster at the Northwest Worm Meeting and co-wrote a micropublication.

Genomic Data Analysis – BIOL 477, WWU — Winter 2025

- Conducted mRNA differential expression analysis on *T. thermophila* datasets using DESeq2 in a Unix environment with Bash, Python, and HPC resources.
- Communicated findings through a written research paper and oral presentation.

Additional Experience

Biotech Research Intern, Rain Incubator – Tacoma, WA — May 2022 – December 2022

- Designed and executed PCR-based experiments for tracking European Green Crab migration; gained experience in hypothesis development and experimental planning.

Club Lead, Molecular Bioscience Club, WWU – Bellingham, WA — August 2025 – June 2026

- Organize events on science advocacy, research opportunities and professional development; assisted students in joining labs.

Computing Education Research, Sushil K. Oswal, UW – Tacoma, WA — February 2023 – May 2024

- Co-authored a paper at ACM SIGCSE on mentorship in STEM education; performed qualitative analysis on interviews and surveys.

Programming Lead, SOTAbots FIRST Team 2557 – Tacoma, WA — September 2019 – June 2023

- Developed competition code for the 2022 FIRST World Championship semi-finals and 2023 district championship; taught Java using industry-standard design patterns.

Skills and Technologies

Wet Lab
- Western Blot
- PCR
- Reverse Transcriptase PCR
- Cell Culture
- Aseptic Technique

Bioinformatics
- Genomic Data Analysis
- DESeq2
- bedtools
- samtools
- Data Visualization (ggplot2, matplotlib)

Programming Languages
- Python
- R
- Java
- C/C++
- SQL
- Bash

Software
- Benchling
- CLI/Git/SSH
- ImageJ
- Jupyter
- Microsoft Office
- SnapGene

Publications and Awards

Publication: Understanding the Leadership Structure and Mentoring Model of an Extracurricular Robotics Team, *SIGCSE 2024*. DOI: 10.1145/3626253.3635603

Posters: Re-identification of genomic origins of sRNAs in *T. thermophila* (WWU SURP 2025); The Role of E2 Ligases ubc-6 and 7 in ERAD in *C. elegans* (NW Worm Meeting 2025); Remapping sRNAs to the 2020 *T. thermophila* Genome (WWU SURP 2024)

Awards: Declan Barron Memorial Scholarship (2025); WWU Biology SURP Award (2025)